CHUKWUMA ZIKORA

DevOps / Platform Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

DevOps and Platform Engineer with 10+ years of software engineering experience, currently focused on infrastructure automation, CI/CD pipeline design, cloud architecture, and container orchestration. Proven record designing and operating deployment infrastructure for healthcare-grade SaaS systems. Operate a self-hosted homelab covering Swarm orchestration, observability, and deny-by-default egress security. Open to DevOps / Platform / SRE roles.

CORE SKILLS

Containers & Orchestration	Docker, Docker Swarm, Kubernetes, Helm, kubeadm
CI/CD & Automation	GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD, CircleCI, Ansible, Vagrant
Cloud & Infrastructure	AWS (Lambda, API Gateway), Proxmox, Linux (Ubuntu)
Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, Grafana Alloy, cAdvisor
Application Development	React.js, Next.js, Node.js, NestJS, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, APIs

INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab and platform labs: github.com/chukwumaijem/playground-devops

Self-Hosted Platform Homelab - Proxmox + Swarm + Observability

2025 - Present

Stack: Proxmox, Docker Swarm, Caddy Docker Proxy, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, Alloy

- Built a multi-VM Proxmox homelab: application Swarm cluster plus a dedicated monitoring VM, with overlay networks separating proxy, backend, and logging traffic.
- Deployed multi-stack microservices with label-driven HTTPS routing via Caddy Docker Proxy (Cloudflare DNS / Let's Encrypt) - no manual proxy rewrites per service.
- Stood up Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, and Alertmanager with provisioned dashboards, container down/restart alerts, and Alloy shipping app-node logs to the monitoring VM.

Deny-by-Default Container Egress Gateway

2025 - Present

Stack: Ansible, Squid, iptables (DOCKER-USER), Docker Swarm

- Designed deny-by-default container egress: direct internet access is dropped; only traffic via a host Squid proxy (HTTP_PR0XY) is allowed.
- Automated install and hardening with Ansible - Squid, domain allowlists, `iptables-persistent`, and DOCKER-USER drop rules on the default-route interface.
- Validated with a Swarm demo: compliant services succeed on allowlisted hosts; rogue containers that bypass the proxy fail.

Kubernetes Multi-Service Packaging with Helm

2025 - Present

Stack: Kubernetes (Minikube, MicroK8s), Helm, Docker Voting App

- Packaged a multi-tier voting application as Helm charts - both a single umbrella chart and per-service charts.
- Practised chart structure, Go templating, values overrides, and install/upgrade workflows for consistent multi-environment deploys.
- Complements hands-on cluster work with Minikube, MicroK8s, and kubeadm (multi-node).

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer | ShiftHealth July 2020 - Present

Remote | Healthcare automation platform (Zapier-style integration engine)

- Designed and built CI/CD pipeline infrastructure using GitHub Actions and Docker, reducing deployment cycle time and eliminating manual deployment errors across a multi-environment healthcare platform.
- Migrated critical system components from traditional server infrastructure to AWS Serverless (Lambda, API Gateway), improving cost-efficiency and enabling elastic scaling for variable workloads.
- Designed and implemented microservices architecture for the team and user management system, improving service isolation, scalability, and independent deployability.
- Built and maintained healthcare system connectors and integration workflows for automated data exchange between clinical and administrative platforms.
- Currently responsible for deployment supervision across fully automated infrastructure; all deployment pipelines are self-designed and self-maintained.

Software Engineer | Unbird July 2019 - June 2020

Remote

- Developed a real-time notification system using WebSockets and implemented granular team permission controls for secure, role-scoped access across multi-tenant workspaces.

Freelance JavaScript Developer | Kwhen September 2017 - June 2019

Remote | Event curation platform

- Integrated multiple third-party event partner APIs and implemented search/filter logic to expand content coverage and improve event discovery.

INDEPENDENT PRODUCTS - BLOCKQUEUE SYSTEMS LTD

Founder of BlockQueue Systems Limited. Built and shipped two production SaaS platforms as sole or lead engineer, owning product architecture, infrastructure design, and cloud deployment.

Lead Engineer - Property Governors 2025 - Present

propertygovernors.com *Stack: Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL · Infra & deployment owned end-to-end*

- Designed and managed all cloud infrastructure and deployment pipelines for a live multi-sided property management SaaS serving users across Nigeria.

Lead Engineer - FirmLyt 2024 - Present

firmlyt.com *Stack: Next.js, Node.js, PostgreSQL, AWS, Docker*

- Handled end-to-end infrastructure design, CI/CD setup, and cloud deployment on AWS for a legal practice management SaaS.

OPEN SOURCE - GITHUB.COM/BLOCKQUEUE

Publishes self-hostable infrastructure tooling under the BlockQueue organisation on GitHub.

Mailer 2025 - Present

github.com/blockqueue/mailer *TypeScript | Apache-2.0 | Docker*

- Self-hostable email orchestration microservice with dual auth (API key + HMAC), rate limiting, YAML-driven config, and Docker deployment.

BQ Queue 2026 - Present

github.com/blockqueue/bq-queue *TypeScript | Apache-2.0 | Docker Compose*

- Self-hostable PostgreSQL-backed job queue and signed HTTP webhook delivery service with idempotency guarantees and full Docker Compose setup.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Nnamdi Azikiwe University, Awka - B.Sc. Computer Science, Second Class Honours (Upper Division)

Udacity - Cloud DevOps Engineering Nanodegree July 2022